

APPEAL A PDD DECISION

Accessible fillable version · The Alberta Disability System Breakdown · September 2026

YOU HAVE 45 DAYS

The clock starts the day they told you the decision. Not the day you opened the letter. If you asked for mediation first, you get 30 days from the day mediation ends instead. Asking PDD to look at it again does NOT stop this clock. Only mediation stops it.

WHAT THIS IS

This is the form you use to ask an independent panel to look at a PDD decision again. They can agree with PDD, change the decision, or overturn it. Their decision is final.

WHAT THIS IS NOT

This is not a government form. The wording is copied from the appeal form written into the PDD rules themselves, so it is the right wording. We rebuilt it because the government file, PDD0021, will not open on a phone. Its own first page says so.

IF A WORD HERE IS NEW TO YOU

We keep a plain list of what these words mean, called The Words They Use. It is free on our site.

WHAT YOU WILL NEED BEFORE YOU START

Get these together first. It is easier than stopping halfway.

- Your decision letter, or the date you were told the decision.
- Your file or reference number, if you have one. It is usually near the top of the letter.
- A rough note of why you disagree. It does not have to be tidy.
- If someone is appealing for you, the paperwork saying you can — guardianship or a personal directive.

STEP 2 — ABOUT YOU

Your full name

Write it the way it appears on your PDD paperwork, if you can.

Your address

This is where they will post things. Include your postal code.

Your phone number

A number they can reach you on. Say if it is better to text.

STEP 3 — WHO YOU ARE APPEALING AS

Tick one. Most people tick the first one.

☐

I am the person the decision is about.

☐

I am their guardian. A court has appointed me to make decisions for them.

☐

I am their agent. They named me in a personal directive to make decisions if they could not.

STEP 4 — THE DECISION YOU ARE APPEALING

What did they decide?

Write what they said no to, or what they cut. Put the date of the letter if you have it. A few sentences is enough. You do not have to use their words.

When did they tell you?

This is the date your 45 days started. If they phoned you first and the letter came later, put both dates and say which was which.

Why do you disagree?

This is the most important box. Say what they got wrong, and say what they did not know when they decided. If your needs have changed since, say that. Plain words are fine. Nobody is marking your spelling.

STEP 5 — WOULD YOU TRY MEDIATION?

Mediation is a meeting with a neutral person who is not from PDD. They help you and PDD try to agree. The mediator does not decide anything. You can still appeal afterwards.

Saying yes here does not cancel your appeal. It pauses the hearing while you try.

☐

Yes, I am willing to try mediation.

☐

No, I want to go straight to the appeal panel.

One thing to check before you tick yes. For PDD, unless you agree otherwise, you and the program split the mediator's costs. Ask what that is likely to be, in writing, before you agree.

SIGN IT

Your signature

Typing your name is enough for most filing. If you print and post it, sign by hand too.

Today's date

Year, month, day.

WHAT HAPPENS AFTER YOU SEND IT

1 They check it.

Someone at the Appeals Secretariat looks at whether the decision can be appealed and whether you filed in time. This is a paperwork check, not a decision on your case.

2 They accept it, or they do not.

If they accept it, it goes to the panel. If they do not, you will be told in writing why.

3 A hearing is set.

The rules say a date must be set within 45 days of a proper notice arriving, or within 30 days if mediation has ended.

4 The panel hears it.

Three panel members normally. The hearing can be held in private if you want that — they have to take your wishes into account.

5 They decide.

They can agree with PDD, change the decision, or overturn it. You get the decision and the reasons in writing. That decision is final.

IF YOU MISSED THE 45 DAYS

You can still ask. The Minister is allowed to give you more time. Write and ask, say why you were late, and say what your appeal is about. If they say no to more time, you cannot appeal that refusal to the panel — but you can contact the Alberta Ombudsman.

WHERE TO SEND IT

Send it to the Appeals Secretariat, and address it to the Minister. That covers every version of the rule, because the Act, the written rules and the government website each say something slightly different. Doing both keeps you safe whichever one they go by.

Ask your Disability Services office to confirm in writing that they received it.

WHAT TO KEEP

- A copy of every page you send, including anything you attach.
- A note of the date you sent it and how you sent it.
- Proof you sent it — a registered mail receipt, or the sent email. Most appeals are lost on the date, not on the facts.

Where these rules come from: the PDD Services Act, sections 15 and 14.1, and the PDD Services Regulation AR 228/2013. Read 28 September 2026.